



Knives Out sequel coming soon

Titled "Glass Onion: A Knives Out Mystery", the movie is expected to come out this holiday season. <https://digit.in/jul22-58>



TDS on Social media influencers

Social media influencers will now have to pay TDS on free gifts they receive from July 1, 2022. <https://digit.in/jul22-60>

have their way, we could see HDDs losing their grip on the mainstream consumer market. Every OEM would want their laptops to be the best in the market and it's only natural for them to push for SSDs over HDDs. But in price-conscious markets like ours, the consumer decides with their wallets and cheaper storage media like HDDs easily win over SSDs. However, it's not just OEMs who have a say in these matters.

As per an executive brief from Trendfocus, a firm that analyses the data storage industry, Microsoft seems to be pushing OEMs to drop

HDDs and switch to SSDs as the primary storage. In practically all laptops above ₹45-50K in India, the primary drive is often an SSD but for everything cheaper than that, the HDD ends up being preferred as the boot drive. OEMs are being asked to make the transition by 2023, a whole year before the previously estimated transition timeline in 2024. Microsoft has an obvious motive here. SSDs are way better in terms of performance and having SSD boot drives makes Windows based machines seem more responsive. And Microsoft also has DirectStorage, a technology aimed at

making compute devices get direct access to storage media without having to rely on intermediary hardware. All of these things obviously help in improving the perception of Microsoft-based devices and that is good enough for Microsoft and OEMs to push for the transition sooner. Hard drives themselves won't be obsolete since data centres are only growing and we'll see a lot more hard drives in data centres until they too feel the need to make the shift. So no, hard drives aren't disappearing for sure, but in practically all devices around you, they will be hard to find. [d](#)

BUYING ADVICE

LAPTOP FOR SIBLING

Q Hey Agent001, My younger brother is about to join college for higher studies and he'll need a laptop for his studies. He's really been pushing for a laptop with a high-end graphics card and as someone who's been in his shoes, I know for a fact that he's thinking about gaming. Not that I have a problem with him gaming but I'd rather not blow a lot of money on getting him a powerful gaming laptop. Please suggest something that is enough for the popular game titles these days. My budget is around ₹80-90K.

—Nagendra V.

A Hey Nagendra, It's a dead give away when someone comes to you asking for a laptop or desktop with "good graphics" that they're looking to play video games. A couple of years ago, this would have meant that you'd have to spend a lot more money in ensuring that there was enough firepower for current gen games but GPUs have improved massively over the years. We now have desktop grade GPUs



HP Pavilion Gaming Laptop

being packed into laptops with slightly conservative power profiles. And games have also improved massively in terms of resource utilisation. Current gen mainstream titles such as Valorant, CS:GO, DOTA 2, Rocket League are not that power hungry and any laptop with even a mid-tier GPU can easily churn out enough frames for a smooth experience.

Since you've mentioned your budget, there are several gaming laptops falling within that price segment. Around the 90K mark, you'll get units

with the RTX 3050 Ti and starting from 70K you should get units powered by the RTX 3050. Both GPUs are decently powerful and will easily handle the popular eSports titles. And having a decent RTX GPU should also help your brother with workloads that require hardware-accelerated ray-tracing. As for recommendations, check out the ASUS TUF Dash F15 with the RTX 3050 Ti and the HP Pavilion Gaming laptops featuring either AMD Ryzen 5000 processors or Intel 11th Gen processors and better. [d](#)